Internal assessment

Draft 1: April 7

Intro to the internal assessment

Class one

The big big big picture

A mandatory portfolio of three commentaries based on published news articles, demonstrating the application of economic theory to real-world situations.

- Weighting:
  - 30% of the final grade for Standard Level (SL).
  - 20% of the final grade for Higher Level (HL).
- Recommended Time: Approximately 20 teaching hours.

Structural overview

- Three Units: Each commentary must cover a different unit of the syllabus:
  - Microeconomics.
  - Macroeconomics.
  - he Global Economy.
- Exclusion: Introduction to Economics cannot be used for a commentary.
- Word Count: Maximum 800 words per commentary.

OK, but what am I actually doing???!!!

Analyze and Apply: Select a contemporary news article and analyze the described economic issue by applying relevant models and theory through the lens of one specific IB key concept.

Evaluate Policies: Provide a balanced, reasoned evaluation of a potential policy solution - either one mentioned in the article or an original suggestion arising from the context - to determine its effectiveness and impact on stakeholders.

Maintain Focus: Ensure all analytical points and evaluative judgments remain strictly anchored in the article's evidence, your chosen concept, and established economic theory.

Article selection rules

- Authentic Sources: Articles must be from published news media (newspapers, journals, or internet sites).
- No Broadcasts: Television or radio transcripts are not permitted.
- Currency: Articles must be published no earlier than one year before the commentary is written. (I suggest within the last 6 months of now.)
- Diversity: You must use a different source for each of the three commentaries.
- Ownership: Students must select their own articles; they cannot be provided by a teacher.

The Nine Key Concepts

Each commentary must use a different key concept as a "lens" for analysis. Using the same concept more than once results in a point penalty.

The 9 Concepts

- Scarcity
- Choice
- Efficiency
- Equity
- Economic Well-being
- Sustainability
- Change
- Interdependence
- Intervention

Marks

The portfolio is marked out of 45 total marks (14 per commentary + 3 for the whole portfolio).

Criterion	Focus	Max Marks
A	**Diagrams** (construction and explanation)	3
B	**Terminology** (appropriate usage)	2
C	**Application and Analysis** (theory in context)	3
D	**Key Concept** (linking the concept to the article)	3
E	**Evaluation** (reasoned judgments)	3
	Total of above	14 x 3
F	**Rubric Requirements** (portfolio diversity/timing, overall)	3

Structure? Something like…

Section	Target Word Count	Essential Elements
1. Introduction	≈100 words	Summarize the article's context, state the real-world issue, define 1–2 core terms, and introduce the Key Concept.
2. Economic Issue & Diagram	≈100 words	Detail the underlying economic problem (e.g., market failure or recessionary gap) and insert your primary diagram.
3. Diagram Explanation	≈150–200 words	Treat the reader as a non-expert. Use step-by-step logic to explain curve shifts, changes in equilibrium, and the resulting price/quantity outcomes.
4. Deeper Analysis	≈100–150 words	Integrate specific data from the article. Discuss elasticities (PED/PES), second-round effects, and the "economic logic" of the events. Perhaps another diagram.
5. Evaluation	≈200–300 words	Apply the CLASPP framework. Offer a balanced argument regarding policy effectiveness, stakeholder impacts, and short-term vs. long-term consequences.
6. Conclusion	2–3 sentences	Provide a final reasoned judgment and explicitly connect the outcome back to your chosen Key Concept.

CLASPP?

- Conclusion (C): Provide a final, definitive judgment on the policy's overall effectiveness.
- Long-term vs. Short-term (L): Distinguish between immediate impacts and delayed consequences over time.
- Assumptions (A): Critique whether theoretical assumptions, such as ceteris paribus or consumer rationality, hold true in the article's context.
- Stakeholders (S): Identify the "winners and losers" by evaluating impacts on consumers, producers, and the government.
- Priorities (P): Determine which economic objective is most critical in this specific real-world scenario.
- Pros and Cons (P): Explicitly weigh the advantages of the situation against the disadvantages.

Use at least three components to ensure a multidimensional, level-7 evaluation.

Yes, we're starting with micro

Look back at topics we covered.

Immediately:

- Which do you think seems most real?
- For which can you immediately think of current events being linked to?

Article hunting!

IB Econ IA possible news sources

Fill in the document with articles…

- Interesting
- 6 months old or newer
- Micro-Economics-y

IB Econ IA initial article consideration

Which shall we focus on today?

How do we choose?

- Interesting
- Connects to concept
- Has connection with theory

Let's give it a go

- *Unstructured at first*
- *Then more structured*

Intro to the internal assessment

Class two

Make a folder in the Economics folder that was created for you. Do all work on Google Docs.

Seriously.

Now.

(I need to be able to look at version history, do track back.)

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80/20

Why? Better feedback. Manage your time. Better insights later. Be fair to Sam.

Sample IAs

A strong commentary

KZ Micro, schedule

Read it.

What do you notice?

What can you learn from it?

Choosing an article

Picking an article. THE ABSOLUTE KEY TO SUCCESS

Good article: Find the Perfect Economics IA Article: A Practical Guide

Basic criteria safe

- Published within 12 months (better 6)
- From a unique news source
- Legitimate news media, not opinion or reports
- Clearly micro, macro, or global economy

Strategically smart

- Neutral reporting, not expert analysis
- Short and focused on one issue

Economically usable

- Describes a clear economic problem
- Includes real data or numbers
- Allows you to analyse and evaluate a policy
- Clearly links to one IB key concept

Final test

- Can it become two definitions, two diagrams, and one evaluation?

Resources/reporting for choosing an article

Use this checklist:

IB Econ IA Article Checklist

Fill out this form. Intention:

- Get you thinking through whether it’s a good idea
- Help me see your thinking so I can approve/reject your article.

Getting started on the commentary

Class three

Quick Q before I forget: anyone double dipping with EE? You can’t.

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What do I write?

Structure?

IB Econ IA structure

Beware AI.

Do not:

- Get AI to write for you
  - Bad at diagram explanation
  - May not hit all points
  - Cheating → no diploma

You may choose to:

- Bounce ideas off AI
- Get high level clarification if you are interpreting something correctly

You should:

- Close the AI tab before writing.

Have you got a Google Doc you're working on that I have access to?

I need to track what you do.

Getting started on the right track. You are ready to start when:

You have an article with a clear, hopefully singular thing to focus on, with some data.

You having clarity about what you're commenting on

You having focus on how you're going to analyse the article.

To get started with CLARITY and FOCUS:

What's the key economic principle/thing/ intervention you're focusing on?

(2 mins)

Make a list of economic concepts and vocab you will use in your analysis

(15 mins)

Go through the textbook to do this.

Draw two graphs, perfectly labelled.

First by hand

Then digitally.

(a lot of minutes)

You might start to describe them today, though you'll end up editing these when you put together the whole commentary.

Crafting the graphs and paragraphs

Class four

Checklist for two graphs and two paragraphs

A reminder about the structure: IB Econ IA structure

Next, use this checklist to check your own work: IB Econ IA graph & desc checklist

Key concept

Refer back to the textbook to check what the key concepts are in *economic terms*, not layman's terms.

You get 3 marks for the key concept! It's seriously important.

Your introduction will state and explain the importance of your key concept.

But don't be one and done! Keep it as an <u>underlying theme,</u> integrated into your response.

Key concept

Bold for Clarity: Bold the concept every time you use it to ensure the examiner cannot miss your application

Economic Context: Always use the concept in a strictly economic sense (e.g., referring to "intervention" as a specific policy tool to correct market failure) rather than its general dictionary meaning

Explain the "Why": Use the concept to explain the motivation behind the events in your diagram, such as why a government decided to step into a market

Connect to Conclusion: Reiterate how the concept summarizes the final outcome of the policy or economic event in your closing sentences

Key concept - example integration

"The government’s decision to implement a $0.20/oz tax represents a significant **intervention** intended to correct the market failure of overconsumption. As shown in Graph 2, this **intervention** increases the firm's costs of production, causing a leftward shift of the supply curve from S to $S+tax$. By using this **intervention** to internalize the external costs of sugary drinks, the government aims to move the market from the inefficient equilibrium at $Q1$ toward the socially optimum quantity at $Qopt$."

Integrate the concept into your paragraphs

Start on you section 1 and 2: IB Econ IA structure

KZ Micro

I prefer to give you a checklist after as otherwise it's very difficult to have your own voice!